

What All the Tests Are Doing

A short, honest explainer of every paper & shadow test in the system — for someone who doesn’t code or trade.

The one thing to understand first

Think of it as a **race between recipes for investing** — run with pretend money. No real dollars are ever at stake. Every “test” is one recipe making daily decisions, and the computer keeps an honest scorecard of how each would have done. The goal is not to get rich fast. The goal is to find out **which recipe is genuinely worth trusting** — and to admit it when the simplest one wins.

Everything below runs by itself once a day. It is a truth-finding machine, not a money machine.

The yardstick

“Just buy the whole market” (S&P 500). Before judging any recipe, we compare it to the simplest thing anyone can do: buy the whole U.S. stock market and hold it. If a fancy recipe can’t beat that, the fancy recipe isn’t worth it. This is the honest bar everything must clear.

The 7 paper tests — recipes that hold pretend positions

These actually “buy” and “hold” pretend investments and track the real returns those choices would have earned. Each one shares the same safety habits: it stays in **cash when things look dangerous**, never bets too much on one thing, and has automatic “stop” switches if losses pile up.

Test	What it holds	The question it’s answering
1 · The Baseline (the proven one)	Calmer, steadier U.S. stocks	This is the recipe we already proved works: it matches the market’s return with about half the scary drops . Every other recipe has to beat this to earn its keep.
2 · Full Stocks	U.S. stocks, full rulebook	Does adding all the extra machinery to stocks beat the simple Baseline — or just add complication?
3 · Crypto	Bitcoin, Ethereum & large coins	Do the same rules work on crypto?
4 · Combined	Stocks + crypto together	Does mixing them — and leaning toward whichever is doing better — help, or just add noise?
5 · Extra Data	Combined + company filings	Honestly tests data our research said hurts . We run it anyway to see if that finding holds up live.
6 · + Gold/Silver	Above + precious metals	Does adding gold & silver (a classic safe-haven) make the ride smoother?
7 · + Bonds	Investment-grade bonds	Does parking our idle cash in bonds (a safer, higher-yield home) earn its place? Just added.

Why a race? Recipe 1 is the reigning champion. If none of 2–7 beats it with pretend money over months, the right answer is simply “keep the simple one.” Proving that a complicated idea doesn’t win is a real, valuable result — and most people never admit it.

The 3 “shadow signals” — advisors that only watch and take notes

These are newer and different: they **don't hold anything and don't touch the money**. They just watch the markets and write down a suggestion or a warning each day, so we can later check — honestly, after the fact — whether listening to them *would have* helped. They can never act on their own.

Advisor	What it watches	What it's trying to tell us
The Fear Gauge (S2)	How nervous the market is vs. how bumpy it's actually been	When investors are paying up for "insurance" against a crash, history says stocks often do better next. Should we lean in at those moments?
The Weather Report (S1)	Four early-warning gauges across different markets at once	Do other markets together warn us to add or cut stock exposure earlier than stock prices alone would?
The Watchdog (S6)	The 7 recipes above	Is any recipe quietly breaking down or losing its edge? It raises a flag for a human to review — it never changes anything itself.

Does it “learn”? Yes — carefully, once a day

It does learn, but **not** second-by-second. Once each weekday it: (1) updates its models with the newest day of data, (2) leans a little more toward whichever recipe has actually been doing well, and (3) hits the brakes on anything losing too much. What it deliberately does **not** do is rewire itself on a whim — a new idea only earns real trust after **~90 days of proof** and a human check. The motto is **“learn constantly, change carefully.”**

The bottom line. Everything here is pretend money used to find the truth. Nothing is promoted to real investing automatically — it has to earn it, over months, against an honest yardstick. The system is built to tell us what actually works, **including when the boring, simple answer is the best one.**

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